Chapter route

Which computing needs and constraints drove OS evolution, and how do historical designs relate to today's abstractions?

Prerequisites are OS fundamentals, process/memory/file abstractions, and architecture history.

- Compare historical systems by requirements/constraints.
- Distinguish inherited concepts from version-specific mechanisms.
- Avoid equating historical products with current systems.

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Concepts migrate without identical implementations

The chapter follows constraint→mechanism→contract, not a strict chronology. Batch sequencing reduces operator waits;spooling decouples device producers/consumers;time sharing adds interaction/CPU reclamation;virtual memory separates information identity from residence.

Constraint	Mechanism	New obligations
Slow manual job changes	Resident monitor	Detect termination/protect monitor
Slow cards/printing	Offline I/O, spool	Queues, capacity, errors/retries
Long exclusive occupancy	Time sharing	Timers, isolation, response, fairness
Expensive fast memory	Paging/backing	Restartable faults, mapping, replacement

Multics, UNIX, and smaller successors share multiuser, hierarchical-file, and sharing concepts. Direct code descent requires source/design evidence beyond conceptual similarity.

Four comparison dimensions

A process can mean static worker, dynamically created process, or a Mach task's thread. Paging can mean relocation without demand loading. Identify:

1. Whether execution agents are dynamic and dedicated per job or reused.
2. Byte/word addressing, page size, and table purpose.
3. Software-layer, privilege, address-space, or machine boundaries.
4. Ownership of faults, timeouts, buffers, and retry/release conditions.

Different answers prohibit transferring modern API/performance promises solely by name. Numerical demonstrations specify rules rather than claim historical measurements.

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From manual operation to resident monitors

Compilation, assembly, loading, running required media changes/termination observation. Batching groups similar needs;monitor control records choose next steps. Controllers/drivers still perform device operations.

Three jobsF, C, F each need2 CPU minutes. Each compiler setup costs 3, including initial setup. Original order has9 setup+6 CPU=15. ReorderingF, F, C has6+6=12, assuming reorderability and excluding response/dependencies.

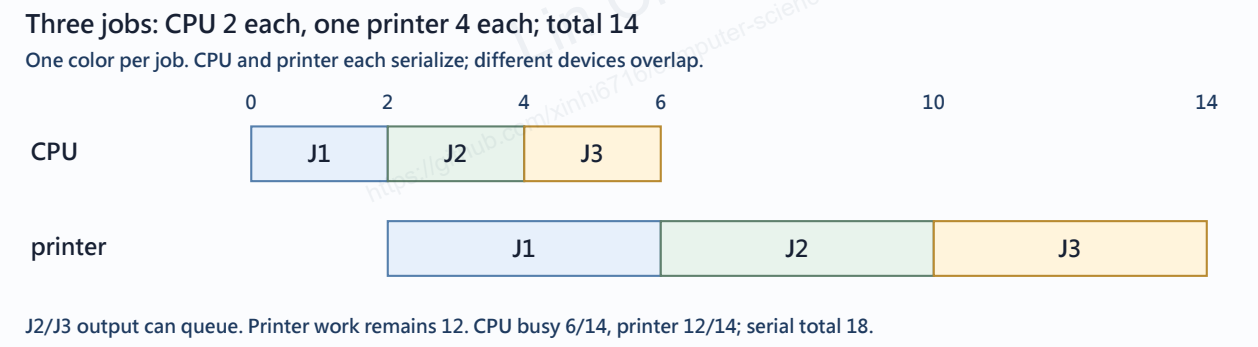
Protect the monitor against user overwrite or halt. Control-record/data separation needs syntax, length, and escaping rules rather than assuming data rarely contains control characters.

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Offline I/O, buffers, spools, and multiprogramming

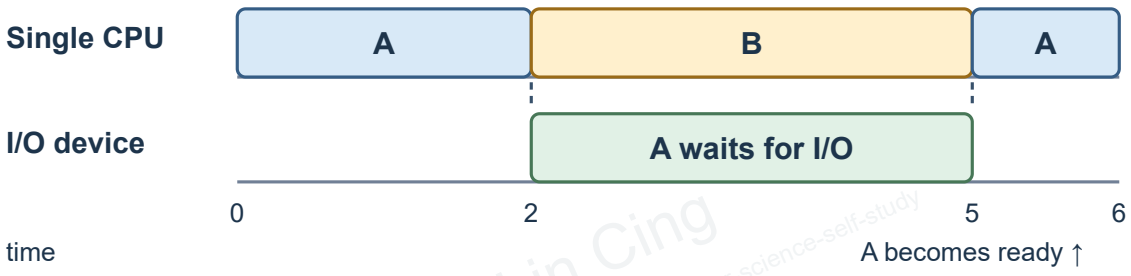
Offline equipment converts cards to tape before mainframe processing, saving host waiting but adding media-batch/movement latency. Buffers absorb production/consumption mismatch until finite capacity backpressures. Disk spools retain independent jobs/data/queue metadata for overlap, unlike imagining random simultaneous access to both tape ends. Multiprogramming separately runs another ready job while one waits, and requires scheduling/isolation.

For three jobs each CPU 2 then print4, with one CPU/printer, CPU runsJ1 0–2, J2 2–4, J3 4–6. Printer runsJ1 2–6, J2 6–10, J3 10–14. Total14, CPU utilization6/14, printer 12/14. Serial execution takes 18. Spooling does not halve the printer's12 units of work.



One CPU can run another process while I/O is pending

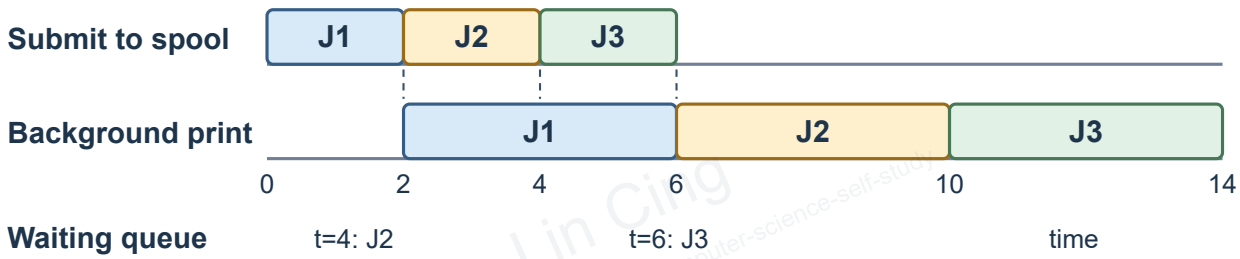
Assume A and B are initially ready, with no switching cost. A runs for 2 units, requests a 3-unit I/O, then resumes for 1 unit after B finishes.



During time 2–5, A waits for the device and B uses the CPU. The CPU and device can be busy together, but a single core does not execute A and B simultaneously. At time 5 A becomes ready and runs. If no process is ready, the CPU may be idle.

Spooling: submission and completed printing are distinct events

One CPU processes J1–J3 in order, each taking 2 units, and submits output to a sufficiently large spool. A FIFO printer takes 4 units per job; printing overlaps CPU work and other costs are ignored.



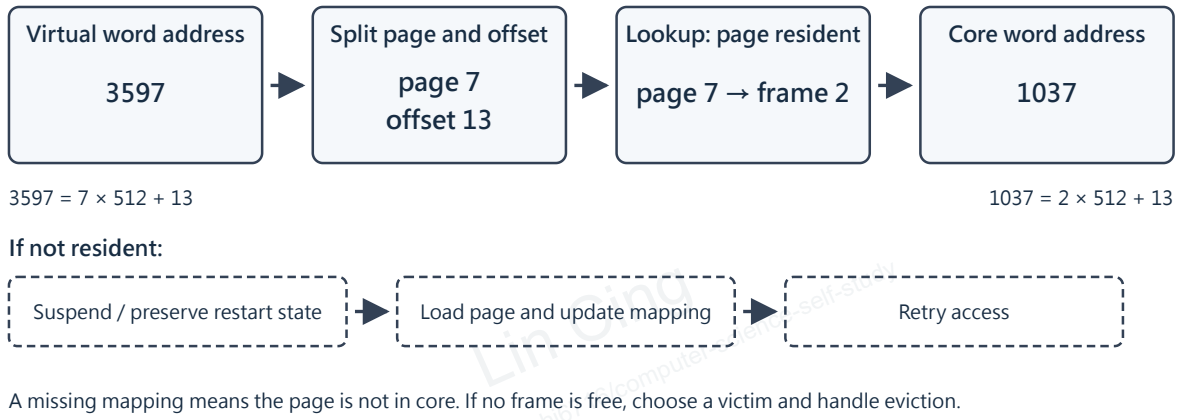
At time 4, J2 is queued while J1 is printing. At time 6, J1 finishes, J2 starts, and J3 waits; all finish at time 14. **Submission is not print completion.** Full queues and device failures require interface-specific handling; buffering and spooling differ by purpose.

Information identity and automatic backing

Atlas combines fast core/drum behind a one-level store with 512-word pages and associative mappings. The book's16 Kiwords core has32 frames, not16 KiB. A four-frame teaching model retains512 words/page.

Virtual word address3597=7 • 512+13 maps page 7→frame 2 to core word address1037. If absent, preserve restartable execution, load into an available frame, update mapping, and retry. One-level store does not make drum as fast/directly accessible as core. Transfers, replacement, and live-frame ownership remain necessary.

Atlas: from a word address to a core frame



A missing mapping means the page is not in core. If no frame is free, choose a victim and handle eviction.

3597 = 7 × 512 + 13; page 7 in frame 2 gives address 1037. A fault requires a frame; evict only when none is free, and write back modified data when needed.

Three learning-replacement branches

Kilburn1962 defines t as time since last use and T as the preceding inactive interval, sampled by executed instructions rather than wall time. Choose first any t>T+1; otherwise among t≠0 choose maximal T−t; otherwise all t=0, choose maximal T. This example breaks ties by table order.

Case	(t, T) entries	Branch/victim
A	(6,3),(2,5),(0,9)	First:6>4, first page
B	(2,4),(1,6),(0,8)	Second:nonzero scores2/5, second
C	(0,2),(0,5),(0,3)	Third:largestT5, second

Past intervals predict future use rather than supply OPT knowledge. A predicted-distant page used next can add a fault. Branch3 makes valid all-recently-used states selectable. Original paper.

Relocation is not demand loading

Historical virtual space16 Kiwords, physical64 Kiwords, page 2 Kiwords give eight virtual pages/process and32 frames. Register-held tables scatter resident pages;whole-image swapping changes resident processes.

P virtual page 3→frame 11, offset 17 gives VA6161 and PA11 • 2048+17=22545 words. No byte conversion or unspecified word width is assumed. A legal missing-page demand fault is additional behavior absent from this relocation-only case. Atlas automatic demand loading and XDS relocation differ despite both having tables.

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Shared code and controlled execution

Two processes each use eight pages. Sharing two safely read-only reentrant code pages needs2+6 • 2=14 frames instead of 16. Shared instruction pages do not privatize a secretly shared writable global buffer;separate code and mutable state.

Converting XDS-930 to940 added user/monitor distinction, privileged I/O/halt, and controlled system calls. Dynamic subprocesses/shared memory additionally require lifecycle, synchronization, termination cleanup. These protections work together.

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Lower-layer contracts before upper-layer reasoning

Dijkstra's THE is batch multiprogramming by cooperating sequential processes, not primarily terminal interaction.

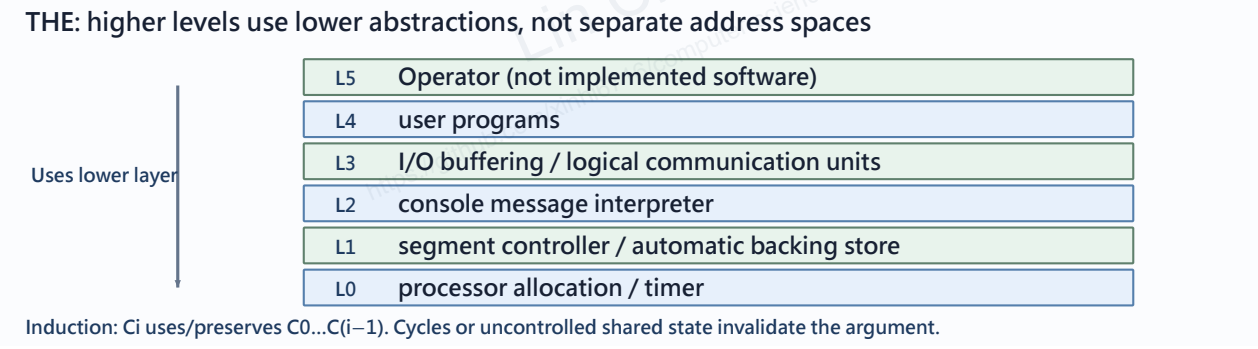
Level	Responsibility/hidden details
0	Processor allocation/timer;sequential-process abstraction
1	Segment controller/backing;information-segment identities
2	Console-message interpreter;physical console allocation
3	I/O buffering/logical communication units
4	User programs
5	Operator, not an implemented software level

Layers describe dependency rather than separate address spaces or mandatory traps. Segments identify information;core/drum pages hold it. EWD196.

Induction over layer contracts

Assume layer i guaranteesCi fromC0…C(i−1), with stated interference constraints, and does not corrupt lower hidden state. Hardware/processor control establishesC0;induction establishes each successive contract. Layering alone proves nothing without those obligations.

Console messages can reside in segments and use level 1 retrieval. If level 1 instead needs level 2 to fetch its own pages, the dependency cycle invalidates bottom-up induction. Synchronization cannot assume relative speed:consume only produced segments, and give a printer only one incompatible owner. Waiting changes progress, not correctness based on "usually slower."



Policy above the nucleus

RC4000 supports constructing different systems rather than hardwiring one batch/time-sharing policy. Nucleus supplies process control, protection, messages. The book's fixed eight-word messages use a shared pool and per-process queues. Send-message/wait-message and send-answer/wait-answer form request/reply. Primitive atomicity protects internal transitions, not an entire server transaction.

Drivers translate registers/interrupts into process-like message interfaces. Devices do not thereby become ordinary processors executing arbitrary user code.

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Conservation with two buffers

Pool={b0, b1};retain one buffer through request/reply completion. This is an ownership model, not instruction-level original-machine emulation.

Step	Free	Server queued/processing	Awaiting client reply
Initial	b0, b1	Empty	Empty
C1 sends	b1	b0 queued	Empty
C2 sends	Empty	b0, b1 queued	Empty
S receives/answers b0	Empty	b1 queued	b0
C1 consumes/returns	b0	b1 queued	Empty

Each buffer has exactly one state;free+queued+processing+reply=2. Third submission must wait/fail as specified rather than allocateb0 again. S waiting for C1 while C1 waits for S still deadlocks. Small kernels/atomic send do not eliminate circular wait.

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Short interaction versus long CPU bursts

MIT CTSS combined interactive time sharing with an existing batch-program environment. Moving user images between limited memory and backing storage makes very short quanta potentially expensive. Compatibility does not promise compatibility with all future APIs; 7090/7094 memory is measured in 36-bit words, not KiB.

Exponential feedback demotes a job that exhausts its quantum and grants longer quanta at lower levels. I/O promotion, aging, and initial level must be specified separately.

Illustrative model: one CPU, no switching overhead. L arrives at t=0 and needs 11 units; S arrives at t=1 and needs 1. New jobs enter level 0 with $q_0=1$; higher levels take priority. L runs [0,1), exhausts its quantum, and is demoted. S runs [1,2), so its response time is 0. Under nonpreemptive FCFS, L finishes at t=11 and S waits 10 units. This result is specific to these jobs and rules.

Complete exponential-feedback trace

Fix $q_i=2^i$, with i starting at 0: one CPU burst of 11 units, initially at level 0. A job is demoted only when it exhausts a quantum without finishing; there are no competing jobs or promotions.

Dispatch	Level	Quantum	Used	CPU total	Remaining
1	0	1	1	1	10
2	1	2	2	3	8
3	2	4	4	7	4
4	3	8	4	11	0

Full quanta through level k total 2^(k+1)−1. **Cost model:** every dispatch costs 0.5, including the initial load and consecutive dispatches of the same job; this does not claim CTSS necessarily swapped on every dispatch. Four dispatches cost 2, yielding total time 13. Fixed RR with q=1 needs 11 dispatches, costing 5.5, for total 16.5. The comparison applies to this burst and cost model only.

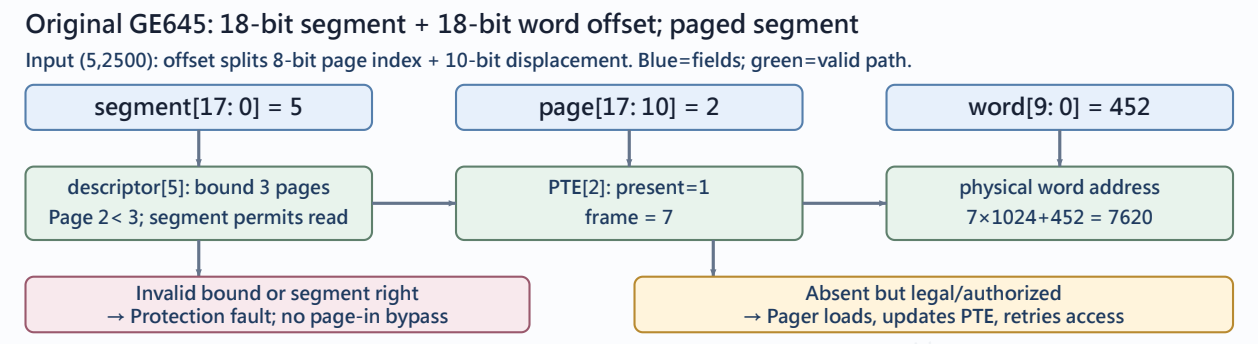
A computer utility with controlled sharing

Multics combined hierarchical naming, segmentation, paging, and controlled sharing. A GE-645 virtual address has an 18-bit segment number and an 18-bit word offset. A page has 1024 words, so the offset splits into an 8-bit page index and a 10-bit page offset. Original GE-645 design

Trace segment 5, word offset 2500: 2500=2×1024+452, hence page index 2 and page offset 452. In this **illustrative state**, the descriptor is valid, its bound permits pages 0–2 and read access is allowed; PTE 2 is present and points to frame 7. Check segment → bound/read permission → PTE 2 → frame 7; the physical word address is 7×1024+452=7620.

An invalid segment descriptor causes a segment fault. A legal segment with an out-of-bounds offset or denied access must be rejected; paging cannot override authorization. Only a legal, authorized nonresident page can be loaded by the pager and retried. Fault recovery depends on system state and is not guaranteed.

A computer utility with controlled sharing (continued)



Rings versus layers

Protection rings constrain access and entry across privilege levels; THE layers organize software abstractions and their dependencies. Modules do not each need their own ring, and a layered diagram alone does not establish access protection.

Distinguish hardware generations: GE-645 provided protection such as segment access modes, but ring-crossing calls and returns trapped to the supervisor and required software intervention. The later Honeywell 6180 design moved most ring checks and cross-ring calls and returns into hardware. See the original paper by Schroeder and Saltzer.

Resolving a segment name does not grant write access: the applicable permissions and entry rules still apply. Shared code and private writable state require mapping and protection contracts. The developers' retrospective records design revisions after integration exposed unexpected path costs.

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Compatibility and allocation variants

System/360 sought common software/tools across capacities. OS/360 MFT uses fixed regions;MVT variable regions. One variant does not specify the entire family.

A 256 KiB example has four64 KiB regions and jobs50,50,70. Two50 jobs waste28 KiB internally. Remaining128 total cannot fit70 into one64 region. This is the chosen configuration, not all possible OS/360 layouts.

Variable holes50,30,40 total 120 but lack a contiguous70, an external-fragmentation example. Moving/compacting requires relocation support/cost;load-time-bound addresses cannot be arbitrarily changed.

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Later virtual memory and CP/CMS

System/370-era OS/VS/MVS uses new VM hardware rather than original360 paging semantics. CP/67 provides VMs;CMS is a single-user system within them. CP supplies multi-CMS isolation rather than CMS itself becoming a shared multiuser kernel.

Two guests can both see address1000 while VMM maps their memory views to different host resources. Mediate guest privilege;guest supervisor status does not authorize arbitrary host writes. Family compatibility, relocation, VM isolation, and interaction are distinct. JCL describes batch resources/steps;option count proves neither correctness nor a fixed performance ratio.

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Interaction and virtual memory

In the book's history, BBN added paging to PDP-10-related hardware and developed TENEX. DEC later acquired rights and formed DECSYSTEM-20/TOPS-20. Command completion/help reduces syntax-memory burden;virtual memory manages addresses/residence. Shell suggestions do not authorize page-table changes, and paging does not infer desired commands.

A machine-like private execution view with many simultaneous users still needs CPU scheduling, terminal I/O, file rights, reclamation. Faster CPUs alone do not provide interaction.

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Usability and security complement one another

In an explicit toy COPY source destination parser, valid syntax creates a request. Execution still checks source read and destination-parent/file write contracts. Autocomplete success does not grant access.

Checking destination then later writing its pathname can race name replacement, as in Chapter 11 TOCTOU. Protected references, clear errors, and understandable interaction must work together. This toy illustrates responsibility, not literal TOPS-20 syntax.

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Resource limits and isolation

CP/M supplies early microcomputer commands/program/device services. MS-DOS follows an IBM-PC single-user/compatibility path. Their protection differs from later multiuser systems;they are not merely smaller NT/Linux.

Counts such as64 KiB/640 KiB must distinguish CPU addressability, conventional layout, OS reservations, and extensions. A common program region is not every version's absolute physical limit.

Without enforced memory isolation, programs can overwrite system data despite APIs instructing them to use services. Hostile programs need not follow conventions. Hardware privilege plus trusted mediation is required.

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A shared-space counterexample

Toy RAM[0,1024) has monitor[0,256), job[256,1024), without hardware bounds. Store100 corrupts monitor even if correct libraries never do so. This is not an actual DOS layout.

Protected base256, limit768 validates0≤a<768 then translates256+a. Addresses−1/768 fail;0/767 reach256/1023. Users cannot modify base/limit. This proves range confinement, not progress against infinite loops, which needs a timer, or shared-file policy. One hardware feature supplies one boundary rather than a full modern OS.

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Desktop interaction versus kernel guarantees

Early Macintosh/Windows made desktop interaction central;later generations added fuller memory, multitasking, networking. Specify generation. Windows 7 here is NT, not early DOS-dependent Windows.

Windows, mouse, menus are interaction models;preemption, address protection, compatibility, drivers are separate. Two windows prove neither parallel processes nor isolated address spaces. A blocked UI thread can freeze a GUI while kernel scheduling continues. Trace event, queue, handler, and awaited service.

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Cooperative and preemptive progress

On one CPU, A loops forever without yield while B is ready. If switching requires yield/block, B may never run. With serviceable timer and a scheduler giving both slices, preemption runsB at a slice boundary.

If A instead loops unbounded in a nonpreemptible kernel lock region, user slices alone cannot guarantee progress. Include kernel/IRQ bounds. This toy compares protocols without classifying every desktop generation identically. Even a scheduledB may wait for A's global resource;preemption does not eliminate deadlock/priority inversion.

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Versioned abstractions

Mach builds on Accent-related research with tasks/address spaces, threads, IPC, VM. A task owns address space/port rights;threads execute and share their task's memory.

Model	BSD placement	Boundary
Mach2.x/2.5	Much remains in kernel	File service need not cross a user server
Mach3 microkernel	UNIX services in user servers	Controlled IPC across address spaces

Kernel-checkable port rights authorize messages;equal integers do not transfer rights across tasks. Shared memory also exists, so not all exchange requires byte-copy messages.

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A fixed IPC cost and isolation model

ClientC sends32 B to user serverS, which replies4096 B. Each direction copies user→kernel→other user twice, without shared-page/out-of-line optimization.

Path	Mode transitions	Address-space changes	Copy bytes
C user→K→S user	2	1	64
S user→K→C user	2	1	8192
Total	4	2	8256

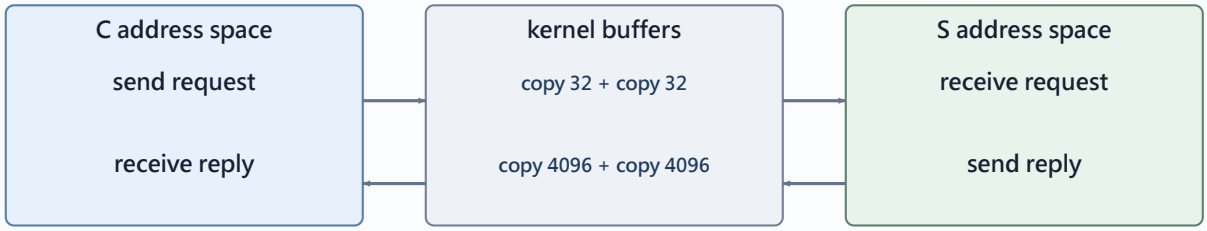
Address protection confines direct corruption from server crash, but client still needs errors, timeouts, reconstruction. Smaller kernel does not prove universal availability. IPC/VM integration can avoid copies while adding mapping, rights, page lifetime, COW costs rather than becoming free.

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A fixed IPC cost and isolation model (continued)

Mach3 copy model: 32 B request +4096 B reply; 8256 B copied

Blue=client C; green=server S; gray=kernel. Two copies/direction, no shared-page optimization.



Controlled kernel transfer: 4 mode transitions,2 address-space changes. Check port rights and buffer lifetime.

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Other systems and unequal processor roles

The book also discusses Burroughs MCP's systems language, segmentation, multiprocessing, and CDC6600 coordination among processing activities. Multiple processors need not be symmetric peers. Identify roles, memory authority, I/O responsibility before applying an SMP scheduler.

High-level languages improve expression, type/module checking, maintenance, while synchronization, ABI, hardware control still need correctness. Assembly does not logically imply failure. Language choice changes inspectable conditions rather than replacing contracts.

Compatibility ecosystems, hardware costs, deployment organizations also affect survival. No single feature here explains commercial success or supplies current-market evidence.

Mechanisms across cases

Problem	Case	Required conditions
CPU/slow-I/O overlap	Monitors/spools	Queues, buffers, ownership, overlappable work
Nonresident information	Atlas	Mapping, restartable fault, total victim selection
Scattered/shared code	XDS-940	Relocation, RO code, private mutable state
Decomposed correctness	THE	Acyclic dependencies, layer contracts
Policy above nucleus	RC4000	Message ownership, pool limits, wait relationships
Interaction/long-burst tradeoff	CTSS	Feedback, promotion, swap-cost rules
Selective sharing/naming	Multics	Separate segment, page, protection
Service isolation	Mach3	IPC rights, address spaces, failure handling

General proofs beyond finite demonstrations

Atlas selects a victim from every nonempty finite frame set: if branch 1 applies, use it; otherwise if any nonzero t exists, a finite maximum score exists; otherwise branch 3 chooses maximal T. This proves total selection, not minimum faults.

Buffer conservation holds initially and under each atomic ownership transition. Appearing simultaneously free and awaiting reply violates that invariant. Layer induction requires Ci to depend only on lower contracts while preserving them; cycles/uncontrolled hidden-state mutation invalidate it.

References and attribution

Lin Cing, handwritten operating systems notes. Silberschatz et al., Operating System Concepts, 9th ed., Ch. 20. Atlas one-level store; THE system; Multics GE-645; Multics protection.

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